The latter is unavoidable because the establishment of a free (or, better, freer and disembedded) trade zone between the USA and Europe and parts of Asia is always linked to expectations of *more* trade, i.e. of *more* production of goods and services, of *more* finance. Thus, free trade is translated into higher economic growth. That is the promise given by the negotiators of the agreement on the Transatlantic Trade and Investment Partnership (TTIP), although it is ridiculously modest: the growth stimulus is calculated to be 0.48%. Nonetheless, it means more growth prerequisites, more consumption of fossil energy, of mineral and agricultural raw materials, more extension of human activities in space, more acceleration in time. This means that at the 'planetary boundaries' (Rockström et al. 2009) which mankind has in some respects already exceeded, free trade triggers growth and, due to the double character of the capitalist accumulation process, not only value production but also the transformation of matter and energy, which inevitably harms nature. The global system of market liberalisation and trade creation is not in balance with the requirements of nature and thus violates the limits of the use of natural resources as well as the carrying capacity of ecosystems. Capitalist dynamics are overshooting the limits of the living and the natural resources of Planet Earth.

Global free trade and the ecological world system

The free trade order comes into existence by removing physical, technical, economic, financial and legal trade barriers. In this process natural obstacles to the free circulation of commodities are also dismantled, due to the double character of economic processes: at the same time commodities have immaterial value but they also represent material and energy transformations. Natural limits, however, are flexible ones and they can therefore be temporarily neglected without sanctions on those who disregard the limits. The neglect and even the violation of limits temporarily has a highly positive but perverse economic welfare effect. The growth rates of GNP in the world are remarkably high since the industrial-fossil revolution in the second half of the 18th century, so that real GNP per capita doubled from one generation to the other. That would be misinterpreted as a quantitative increase only. It was, and still is, a qualitative change, if not a revolution. Dialectics of nature therefore matter, as Friedrich Engels (1983) showed.

It is not always taken into consideration that this economic miracle for human beings has an ugly, seamy side: the negative effects on nature, the much too large 'ecological footprint' of economically rich humans. But the negative effects are understood as market externalities. Therefore they are traditionally beyond the